

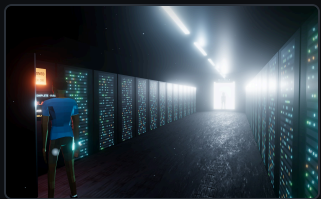
CGV GROUP PROJECT · STORY CONCEPT · LEVELS 1-3

BLACKOUT PROTOCOL

One chase, three games. You run, then you drive, then you stop running and turn around. This is the whole story, start to finish, rendered in our engine with our own characters.



How the three levels connect



PROLOGUE

01:48. Kai copies the Key to BLACKOUT.



L1 · DOWNLINE

Run the flooded metro. He is 15 m behind.



THE GATE

The seal locks between them. He climbs.



L2 · REDLINE

The N3 at sunset. Now he can hurt you.



THE FALL

Rammed off the bridge into the river.



L3 · ACT III

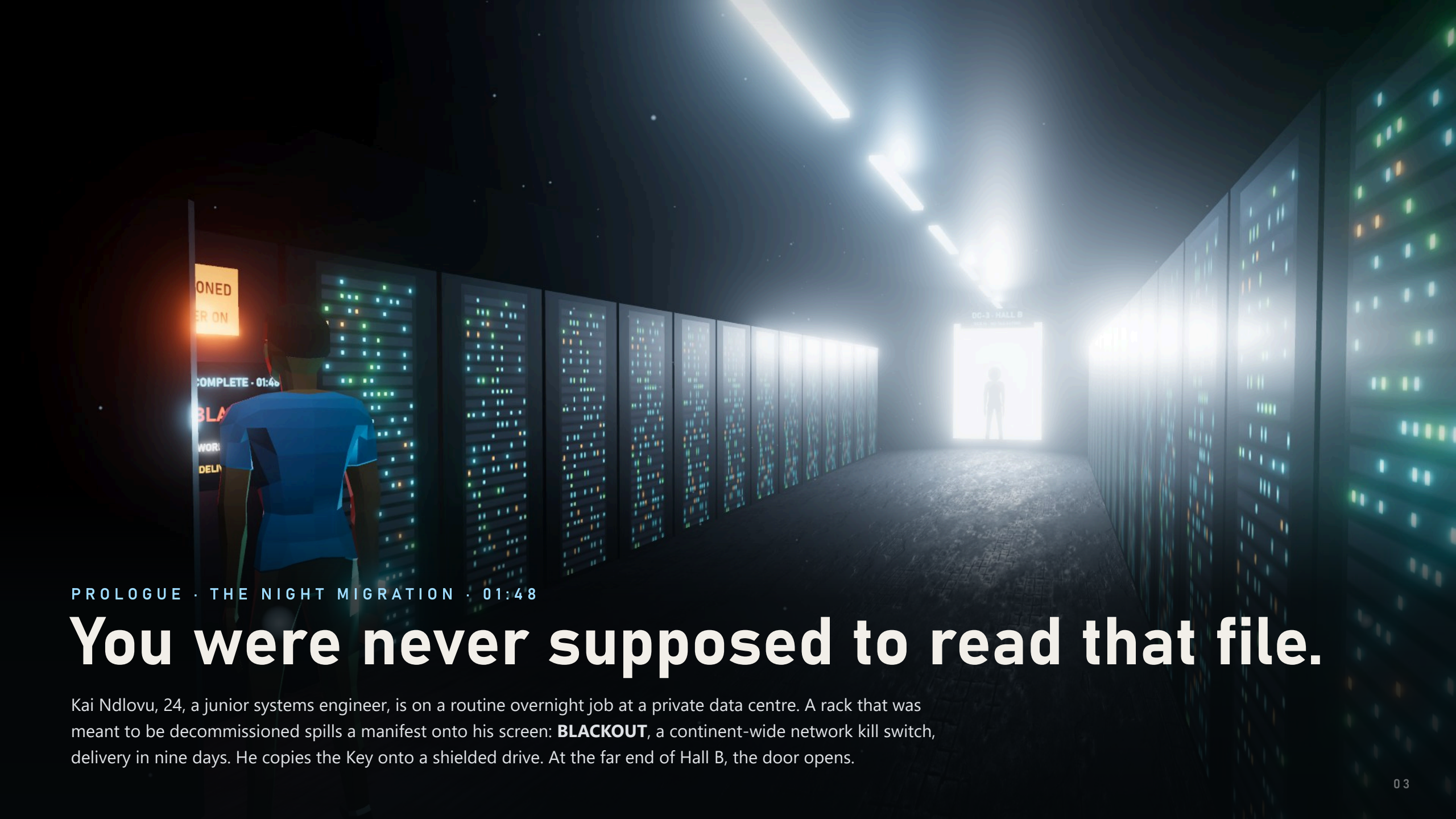
The river decides where he wakes. Pick 1 of 4.



THE REVEAL

The helmet comes off. You know that face.

THREAD	LEVEL 1 · RUN	LEVEL 2 · DRIVE	LEVEL 3 · FIGHT
THE KEY	On Kai's back	Bolted into the car	In his fist (it glows cyan in every shot)
THE HANDLER	A shape behind a torch beam	Headlights in the mirror	A face: the man who recruited him
THE COST OF A MISTAKE	Distance	Damage	Health, with nowhere left to run
COLOUR	Cold cyan and steel	Magenta dusk into night	The arena's own palette
THE NUMBER 7	Platform 4 · Sector seal 043	N3 South · Toll 2 km	Site 7 · Relay 7 · Station 7 · the pass, whichever arena wins



PROLOGUE · THE NIGHT MIGRATION · 01:48

You were never supposed to read that file.

Kai Ndlovu, 24, a junior systems engineer, is on a routine overnight job at a private data centre. A rack that was meant to be decommissioned spills a manifest onto his screen: **BLACKOUT**, a continent-wide network kill switch, delivery in nine days. He copies the Key onto a shielded drive. At the far end of Hall B, the door opens.



PLATFORM 4
SOUTHBOUND

02:20 SOUTHBOUND - DELAYED
HE'S STILL COMING

LEVEL 01 · RUN · DOWNLINE

The Metro

Rosebank interchange, 02:14. Closed, half-flooded, and not empty.



Runner camera with the distance meter, letters found and a letter card. The 02:20 southbound is coming down the left lane.

The cameras own the street, so Kai goes under it. Three lanes: jump, slide, don't stop. Behind him a man has not once broken stride. You can't hurt him and he can't reach you; every mistake just closes the gap.

The Metro

WHAT'S NEW

The core runner loop. The only currency is distance: every clipped barrier hands him three metres.

LETTERS ON THE ROUTE

- *"They told you that rack was decommissioned. It was signed for on Tuesday."*
- *"Twelve names on the manifest. Yours is the only one still breathing."*
- *"He isn't chasing the drive. He's chasing you."*

BOARDS SHOUT

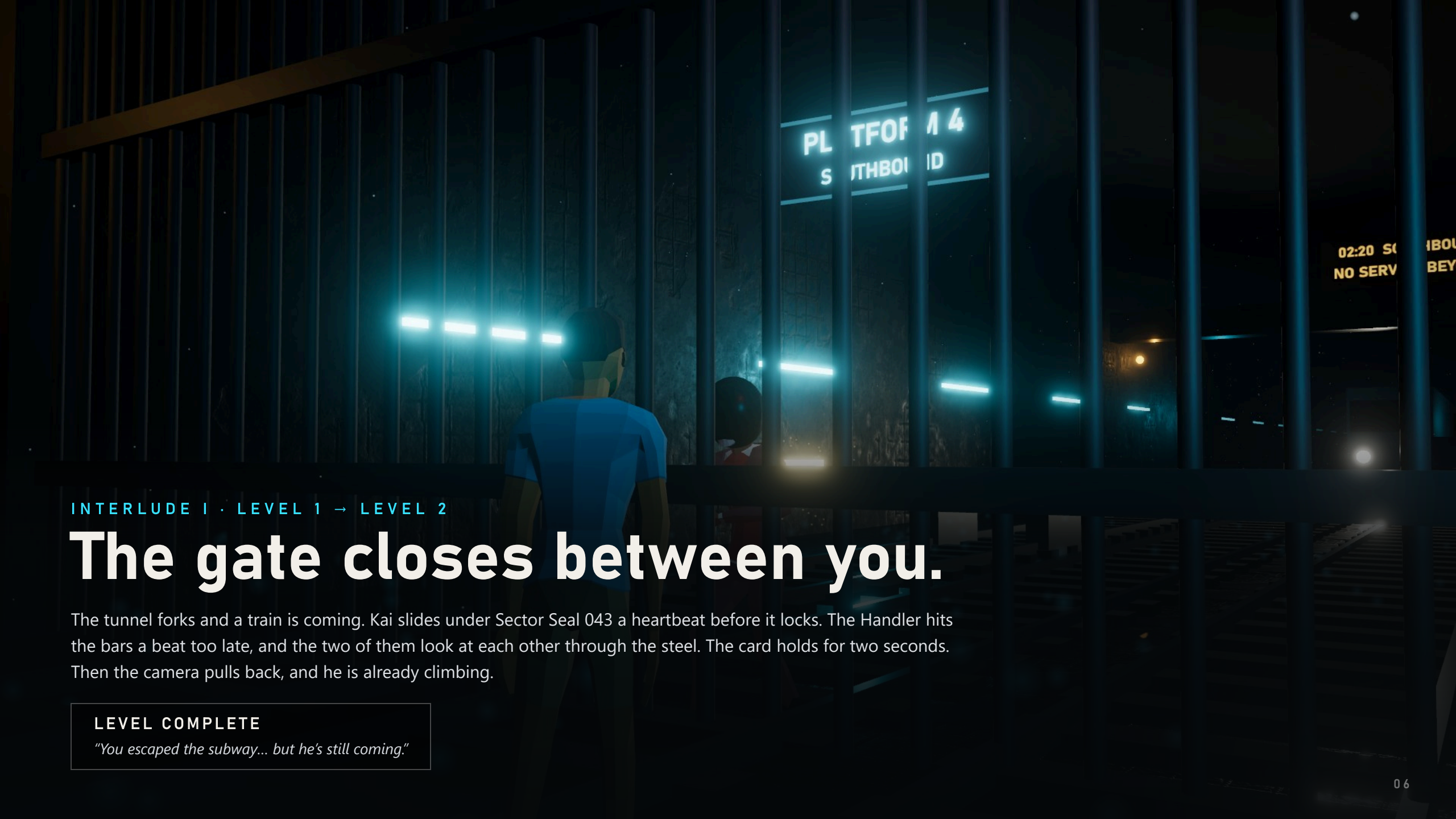
PLATFORM 4 SOUTHBOUND · HE'S STILL COMING · SECTOR 2 CLEAR

WHAT WILL KILL YOU

The oncoming train, the third rail, ticket barriers, luggage trolleys, closing sector gates, ceiling ducts.

SHADER & EFFECTS

Speed-warp shader, wet-floor reflections (shown), shadow-casting headlight, cyan emergency lighting.

A character in a blue shirt is seen from behind, looking through a metal gate. The gate is made of vertical bars. In the background, there is a subway platform with a sign that reads "PLATFORM 4" and "SOUTHBOUND". There are also some lights and a clock on the wall.

INTERLUDE 1 · LEVEL 1 → LEVEL 2

The gate closes between you.

The tunnel forks and a train is coming. Kai slides under Sector Seal 043 a heartbeat before it locks. The Handler hits the bars a beat too late, and the two of them look at each other through the steel. The card holds for two seconds. Then the camera pulls back, and he is already climbing.

LEVEL COMPLETE

"You escaped the subway... but he's still coming."



LEVEL 02 · DRIVE · REDLINE

The Highway

The N3 out of the city. Sunset bleeding into night, and now he can hurt you.

LEVEL 02 · DRIVE · REDLINE · IN-GAME VIEW



Chase camera with car integrity, speed and boost heat. The rear-view inset shows his SUV on your bumper, and the minimap tracks the traffic.

A contact is waiting past the toll. He never arrives, because he never left the building. Six lanes, freight trucks and rain on the way. The Handler rams, shoots out tyres and drops drones. Mistakes now cost paint, then panels, then the car.

The Highway

WHAT'S NEW

A vehicle: momentum, drift and boost. For the first time, a health bar.

LETTERS ON THE ROUTE

- *"Your contact never left the building."*
- *"You were selected six months ago. The job was the interview."*
- *"The Act III location isn't a hiding place. It's an address." (the wording follows the chosen arena)*

BOARDS SHOUT

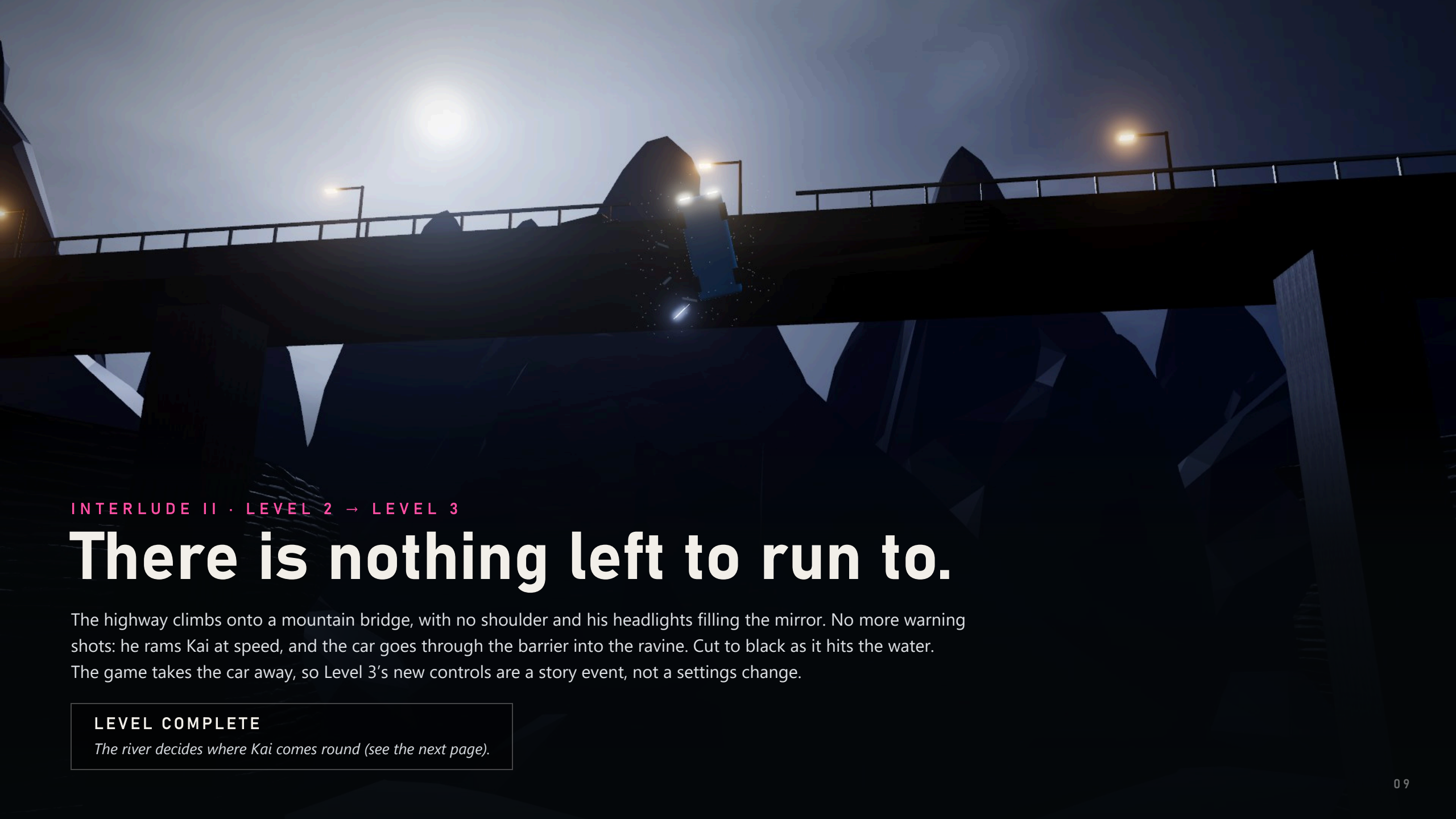
N3 SOUTH · TOLL PLAZA 2 km · NO SERVICE BEYOND THIS POINT

CAMERA LANGUAGE

Rear-view picture-in-picture and an orthographic minimap (both shown, both real renders).

SHADER & EFFECTS

Dynamic sky from dusk to night, wet-road reflections, rain, sodium streetlights, headlight beams.

A dark, stylized illustration of a car falling off a bridge at night. The car is a small, blue, boxy shape falling from the edge of a dark bridge. The bridge has a railing and is lit by a few streetlights. The background is a dark, hazy night sky with a bright, glowing light source, possibly the moon or a distant star. The overall mood is somber and dramatic.

INTERLUDE II · LEVEL 2 → LEVEL 3

There is nothing left to run to.

The highway climbs onto a mountain bridge, with no shoulder and his headlights filling the mirror. No more warning shots: he rams Kai at speed, and the car goes through the barrier into the ravine. Cut to black as it hits the water. The game takes the car away, so Level 3's new controls are a story event, not a settings change.

LEVEL COMPLETE

The river decides where Kai comes round (see the next page).

Where does the river take him?



A · Overgrown Shrine (theme plan

pick)

The river under the bridge runs into the jungle and drops him into a pool at the foot of a waterfall. Behind it is a stone gate with a laminated sign zip-tied to the pillar.

SITE 7 · NO ENTRY

"You got off the road. Now there's only the river."



B · Cliffside Monastery

The current carries him down the valley. He climbs the pilgrim steps toward the only lights for miles and reaches a terrace with a sign that has no business being this far up a mountain.

PASS CLOSED · NO SERVICE

"You got off the road. Now there's only up."



C · Desert Canyon Outpost

The river carves out of the mountains into a box canyon and leaves him on a sandbar. Up the bank stands a red-and-white mast and a sun-bleached relay station, with its door ajar.

RELAY 7 · DECOMMISSIONED

"You got off the road. Now there's only the canyon."



D · Coastal Cliffs

The river reaches the sea and throws him onto the shingle under a sea stack. A bunker sits on top, with an antenna blinking red and a sign on the beach.

STATION 7 · RESTRICTED

"You got off the road. Now there's only the edge."

The prologue, Levels 1 and 2 and both interludes are identical in every branch. Only where Kai wakes, the arena, and one line of the Level 2 letter change. Each option gets two pages next.



LEVEL 03 · FIGHT · OPTION A · SITE 7 · THEME PLAN PICK

Overgrown Shrine

A forgotten jungle shrine, quietly wired into the network.

OPTION A · ACT III IN THREE BEATS



The river under the bridge runs into the jungle and drops him into a pool at the foot of a waterfall. Behind it is a stone gate with a laminated sign zip-tied to the pillar.



The courtyard is ringed by broken columns and guardian statues. A fibre cable runs into the gate, where the uplink is hidden. It's golden hour, with sun shafts and pollen in the air.



Phase II: the helmet comes off. It's the man who signed Kai onto the contract six months ago.

LETTERS IN THIS ARENA

- "You were meant to find it."
- "He wrote your recruitment letter. Compare the handwriting."
- "Eleven more keys. Eleven more of you."

Level 2's third letter becomes: "The shrine isn't a hiding place. It's an address."

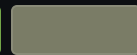
LOOK & SHADER

Golden hour · moss · warm stone

Signature shader: Flowing waterfall and pool



#5f9a2e



#7a7c66



#f4e2b0



#2f7f7a



#3f1d0c

FOR / AGAINST

- Every asset is already in hand
- Bright and readable, with a round arena like the current one
- A lot of foliage to keep fast on laptops



LEVEL 03 · FIGHT · OPTION B · THE PASS

Cliffside Monastery

No way out but down.

OPTION B · ACT III IN THREE BEATS



The current carries him down the valley. He climbs the pilgrim steps toward the only lights for miles and reaches a terrace with a sign that has no business being this far up a mountain.



An open terrace with a sheer drop on one side and a gothic monastery on the other. Prayer flags snap overhead and torches burn in the arches. The uplink is in the bell tower.



Phase II: the helmet comes off. It's the man who signed Kai onto the contract six months ago.

LETTERS IN THIS ARENA

- "You were meant to find it."
- "He wrote your recruitment letter. Compare the handwriting."
- "Eleven more keys. Eleven more of you."

Level 2's third letter becomes: "The monastery isn't a hiding place. It's an address."

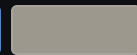
LOOK & SHADER

Cold morning · red banners · torchlight

Signature shader: Drifting mist banks below the terrace



#3f74b8



#9c988e



#a3262a



#f4f7fb



#ff9a4a

FOR / AGAINST

- The most epic silhouette
- The cheapest shader of the four
- The provided HDRI is a city street, so the sky stays painted



LEVEL 03 · FIGHT · OPTION C · RELAY 7

Desert Canyon Outpost

Dead tech under a burning sky.

OPTION C · ACT III IN THREE BEATS



The river carves out of the mountains into a box canyon and leaves him on a sandbar. Up the bank stands a red-and-white mast and a sun-bleached relay station, with its door ajar.



A cracked concrete pad between sandstone walls. Through the open door, the server rack the whole game has been about blinks cyan.



Phase II: the helmet comes off. It's the man who signed Kai onto the contract six months ago.

LETTERS IN THIS ARENA

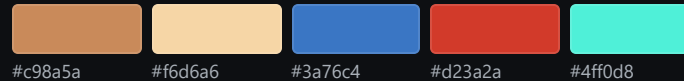
- "You were meant to find it."
- "He wrote your recruitment letter. Compare the handwriting."
- "Eleven more keys. Eleven more of you."

Level 2's third letter becomes: "The relay isn't a hiding place. It's an address."

LOOK & SHADER

Late afternoon · sandstone · server glow

Signature shader: Heat haze over the sand (reuses the lava maths)



FOR / AGAINST

- Keeps the warm Deephold palette
- The server room is on screen, so the set tells the story
- Canyon walls can feel enclosed



LEVEL 03 · FIGHT · OPTION D · STATION 7

Coastal Cliffs

The last stand at the edge of the world.

OPTION D · ACT III IN THREE BEATS



The river reaches the sea and throws him onto the shingle under a sea stack. A bunker sits on top, with an antenna blinking red and a sign on the beach.



An exposed rock shelf thirty metres above the ocean at sunset, beside the uplink bunker, with a lighthouse blinking on the headland.



Phase II: the helmet comes off. It's the man who signed Kai onto the contract six months ago.

LETTERS IN THIS ARENA

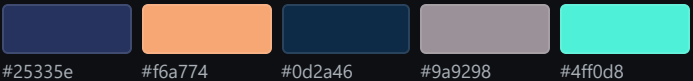
- "You were meant to find it."
- "He wrote your recruitment letter. Compare the handwriting."
- "Eleven more keys. Eleven more of you."

Level 2's third letter becomes: "The station isn't a hiding place. It's an address."

LOOK & SHADER

Sunset · backlit · sea glitter

Signature shader: Animated ocean (waves, sun glint, foam)



FOR / AGAINST

- The biggest "wow" of the four
- Open horizon, no walls needed
- Backlit fighters need a fill light
- The ocean shader is the most work

EPILOGUE · AFTER THE FIGHT

Eleven more.

The upload finishes. BLACKOUT is public, and a kill switch everyone knows about is worthless. Kai finally breathes. Then the Handler's phone lights up on the ground beside the helmet, with something else he was never meant to read.

TRUE ENDING · FOR COLLECTORS

Find all three letters in every level (nine in total) to unlock the lore terminal and the true ending. That covers the rubric's "replay value" by name.

TRAILER EDIT, ALREADY STORYBOARDED

RUN in cyan → **DRIVE** in magenta → **FIGHT** in the arena's colour → title card → "Eleven more."

UPLOAD · 100%

BLACKOUT master key published to 214 mirrors.

HANDLER-01 · NEW MESSAGE

Asset 1 compromised. Proceed with the remaining keys.

MANIFEST · KEYS

KEY-02 · KEY-03 · KEY-04 ... KEY-12

11

OTHER KEYS

Choosing Act III

	A · Overgrown Shrine	B · Cliffside Monastery	C · Desert Canyon Outpost	D · Coastal Cliffs
Where Kai wakes	The river under the bridge runs into the jungle and drops him into a pool at the foot of a waterfall.	The current carries him down the valley.	The river carves out of the mountains into a box canyon and leaves him on a sandbar.	The river reaches the sea and throws him onto the shingle under a sea stack.
Signature shader	Flowing waterfall and pool	Drifting mist banks below the terrace	Heat haze over the sand (reuses the lava maths)	Animated ocean (waves, sun glint, foam)
Mood	Golden hour · moss · warm stone	Cold morning · red banners · torchlight	Late afternoon · sandstone · server glow	Sunset · backlit · sea glitter
Main risk	Foliage performance	Distant mountains look simple	Feels enclosed	Ocean shader time

Whatever wins: the combat, Kai, the Handler, the FightHUD, the Key and the reveal are the same code in all four. Only the arena dressing, the lighting, the sky and one shader in `Level103.js` change.

TEAM VOTE

Pick the arena for Act III

Name	A	B	C	D

Write **1** for your first choice and **2** for your second. 1st = 2 pts, 2nd = 1 pt. Most points wins.

Already locked (not up for a vote)

- Prologue in the data centre, 01:48
- Level 1 Downline (metro, run) and Interlude I, The Gate
- Level 2 Redline (highway, drive) and Interlude II, The Fall
- The helmet reveal and the “Eleven more” epilogue

Decided by this vote: where the river leaves Kai, the Act III arena, its shader, and one line of the Level 2 letter.